

VITO LEONE

ROME, ITALY

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Independent applied research portfolio

Human Nutrition | Food Systems | Public Health Nutrition |
Data & Evidence

I translate nutrition science, public-system information and structured data
into applied evidence for food-system and public-health decision-making.

FLAGSHIP CASE STUDY

Italian School Meals Observatory

A multi-municipality pilot on menu provision, governance and outcome transparency in Italian school-food systems.

7 municipalities	170 coded lunches	12 governance domains	10% stratified QA audit
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THE PROBLEM

Municipal school-meal systems publish menus, procurement requirements and control procedures, but information is fragmented across documents and often less complete for measurable outcomes such as plate waste, dish acceptance, non-conformities or achieved sourcing shares.

MY APPROACH

- **Research design** - Defined the analytical framework, sampling rules and operational codebook.
- **Menu coding** - Standardised one scheduled school lunch per row across seven purposively selected municipalities.
- **Governance review** - Mapped 12 domains spanning controls, procurement, participation, special diets, sustainability and outcome reporting.
- **Evidence discipline** - Kept unknown information as NA; separated tender requirements from observed provision; avoided quality rankings.

METHOD SNAPSHOT

UNIT OF ANALYSIS One scheduled school lunch day.

SAMPLING Full cycle for menus up to nine weeks; four sentinel weeks for long annual calendars.

CODING RULE Dish names coded conservatively; no micronutrient adequacy inference from menu labels.

PROVENANCE Season and source version tracked; prospective tender menus separated from observed provision.

QA 17/170 rows audited with fixed seed 20260920, covering all seven municipalities.

QA IN ACTION

The audit identified a Rome source-version discrepancy. Rather than patching one sampled row, all 45 Rome rows were re-coded against the applicable official menu source. Post-correction sampled binary agreement: 17/17.

WHAT THE PILOT SHOWED

The strongest cross-cutting signal was not a simple menu “winner”, but a transparency gap between documented service design and publicly available implementation outcomes.

01 MENU ROTATION Fish and legume frequencies were relatively convergent across the seven cases. Menu coding is useful for describing provision, but it does not by itself establish actual intake or service quality.	02 GOVERNANCE Controls, meal commissions, procurement clauses and special-diet procedures are often well documented - but the depth and accessibility of evidence varies by municipality.
03 OUTCOME GAP Plate waste, detailed dish acceptance, non-conformities, penalties and achieved sustainable-procurement shares were frequently harder to retrieve than rules or planned processes.	04 INTERPRETATION Procurement requirements were treated as requirements, not achieved performance. Documentation availability was analysed as its own dimension rather than used as a proxy for service quality.

OUTPUTS

- QA-audited master workbook and coded menu dataset
- Standardised governance matrix across 12 domains
- Technical report and one-page executive summary
- Reproducible analysis pack and R workflow
- Targeted public-data request framework for outcome evidence

CURRENT PHASE

Outcome-data collection is now active across all seven municipalities through targeted access-to-information requests. The next iteration will integrate returned reports and datasets without altering the frozen v1.0 codebook unless a documented methodological revision is required.

PROJECT PRINCIPLE

Published menu provision != individual consumption. Public procurement requirements != achieved performance. Missing public evidence != poor service.

WHY THIS PROJECT MATTERS

The Observatory is the core proof-of-work in this portfolio: a documented end-to-end workflow from question definition and source review to coding, QA, interpretation, reporting and targeted data acquisition. It is intentionally presented as a pilot, not as a nationally representative assessment.

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

A multidisciplinary profile combining human nutrition, food science, community-facing health support and applied evidence work. The focus is increasingly on public health nutrition and food systems: understanding how services are designed, monitored and translated into measurable outcomes.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

INDEPENDENT NUTRITION PRACTICE

2021-2023

Nutrition assessment, dietary counselling, evidence translation and direct client communication. This experience developed the ability to move from scientific information to practical, person-facing recommendations.

PHARMACY - DIAGNOSTIC TESTING SUPPORT

2023-2026

Community-facing support for blood pressure, blood glucose, lipid profile, ECG, Holter and spirometry services, alongside supplement and wellness guidance. The role strengthened practical communication, service delivery and health-data familiarity.

METHODS & EVIDENCE WORK

- Research question framing and pilot-study design
- Structured public-document review and evidence extraction
- Codebook development and rule-based data coding
- Data cleaning, provenance tracking and quality assurance
- Menu and food-service analysis
- Governance and procurement mapping
- Monitoring-framework design and gap identification
- Technical reporting and evidence translation

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Human Nutrition Sciences (LM-61)

Universita Telematica San Raffaele Roma, 2018-2020.

B.Sc. Food Science & Gastronomy / L-26 background

Universita Telematica San Raffaele Roma, 2013-2016.

Pharmacy (LM-13)

Sapienza University of Rome - ongoing studies.

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Excel - Advanced; structured workbooks, cleaning, summaries and QA workflows.

R - Working knowledge; reproducible analysis workflow prepared for the Observatory.

Access / SQL - Working knowledge for structured data and querying.

Microsoft Office - Professional document, spreadsheet and presentation workflow.

Scientific literature - Search, critical reading and evidence synthesis for nutrition and food systems.

PROFESSIONAL INTERESTS

- School food systems
- Public health nutrition
- Sustainable food procurement
- Food-system monitoring
- Functional foods
- Fermentation
- Microbiome

These are areas of professional interest and future development; they are not presented here as completed research projects.

AVAILABLE PROJECT OUTPUTS

Technical Report	Executive Summary	QA-audited Dataset	Governance Matrix	FOIA/Data Request Tracker
Open to food-systems, public-health nutrition and applied evidence roles.				vitoleone.nutrizione@gmail.com